



Bridging to Certification

AWS Academy Cloud
Architecting



Introduction

Bridging to Certification

Module objectives

This module prepares you to do the following:

- Identify how to prepare for the AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate exam.
- Find resources to prepare for the exam.

Module overview

Presentation sections

- Solutions Architect – Associate certification domains
- Solutions Architect – Associate certification exam resources
- Additional resources

About AWS Certification exams

Exam content

- Content is divided into domains and task statements.
- Each domain is weighted.
- Questions include multiple choice and multiple response types.

Exam scoring

- Exams have a pass or fail designation.
- Unanswered questions are scored as incorrect.
- Each exam includes some unscored questions that do not affect your score.

About the Solutions Architect – Associate Certification

Recommended candidate for exam

- Performs a solutions architect role
- Has at least 1 year of hands-on experience designing cloud solutions that use AWS services.

Knowledge and skills validated by the exam

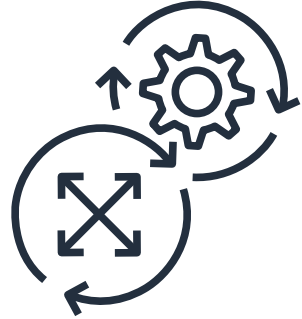
- Ability to design solutions based on the AWS Well-Architected Framework
- Ability to complete the following tasks:
 - Design solutions that incorporate AWS services to meet current business requirements and future projected needs.
 - Design architectures that are secure, resilient, high-performing, and cost-optimized.
 - Review existing solutions and determine improvements.



Solutions Architect – Associate Certification domains and task statements

Bridging to Certification

Solutions Architect – Associate content domains



Domain 1 (30%)

Design Secure
Architectures

Domain 2 (26%)

Design Resilient
Architectures

Domain 3 (24%)

Design High-
Performing
Architectures

Domain 4 (20%)

Design Cost-
Optimized
Architectures

Certification content domain 1 task statements

Design Secure Architectures (30%)

- 1.1: Design secure access to AWS resources.
- 1.2: Design secure workloads and applications.
- 1.3: Determine appropriate data security controls.

Certification content domain 2 task statements

Design Resilient Architectures (26%)

2.1: Design scalable and loosely coupled architectures.

2.2: Design highly available and/or fault-tolerant architectures.

Certification content domain 3 task statements

Design High-Performing Architectures (24%)

3.1: Determine high-performing and/or scalable storage solutions.

3.2: Design high-performing and elastic compute solutions.

3.3: Determine high-performing database solutions.

3.4: Determine high-performing and/or scalable network architectures.

3.5: Determine high-performing data ingestion and transformation solutions.

Certification content domain 4 task statements

Design Cost-Optimized Architectures (20%)

- 4.1: Design cost-optimized storage solutions.
- 4.2: Design cost-optimized compute solutions.
- 4.3: Design cost-optimized database solutions.
- 4.4: Design cost-optimized network architectures.



Solutions Architect – Associate Certification exam preparation resources

Bridging to Certification

AWS Certification resources

Webpage address	Description
https://aws.amazon.com/certification	AWS Certification overview: Includes links to resources and information about each certification
https://aws.amazon.com/certification/certified-solutions-architect-associate	AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate Certification: Includes details about the Solutions Architect – Associate exam with links to exam guide, sample questions, and available training

Free exam readiness resources

Title	Description
Exam Guide	• PDF document that explains the test and the certification domains in detail • Appendix includes technologies and concepts that might appear on the exam, and in-scope and out-of-scope AWS services and features
Sample questions	• PDF document with ten questions that demonstrate the format of the questions used on the exam • Includes rationales for the correct answers
AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate webinar	• 3-hour virtual event that explores topic areas and how they map to architecting on AWS and to specific areas of study • Requires registration
Exam Prep Standard Course: AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate	• Digital training course that walks you through each of the domains, explaining what you should know • Includes reviews of exam-style questions • Requires an AWS Skill Builder account
Exam Prep Official Practice Question Set: AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate	• 20 exam-style questions delivered online in a format similar to the certification exam • Includes detailed feedback and recommended resources to help you prepare for your exam • Requires an AWS Skill Builder account

Exam readiness with an AWS Skill Builder subscription



AWS Certified
Solutions Architect - Associate
(SAA-C03)

Official Practice Exam

Exam Prep Official
Practice Exam: AWS
Certified Solutions...

REQUIRES SUBSCRIPTION

EN | 2h 10m  4.0

 Digital training



New

AWS Certified
Solutions Architect - Associate
(SAA-C03)

Enhanced Exam Prep Course

Exam Prep Enhanced
Course: AWS Certified
Solutions Architect -...

REQUIRES SUBSCRIPTION

EN | 9h 30m  5.0

 Digital training



Solutions Architect **New**

AWS Cloud Quest: Solutions
Architect

REQUIRES SUBSCRIPTION

EN  5.0

 Digital training



Additional resources

Bridging to Certification

AWS Well-Architected Framework



Operational
Excellence



Security



Reliability



Performance
Efficiency



Cost
Optimization



Sustainability

Centralized hubs for finding AWS resources

Description	Webpage
AWS Architecture Center	https://aws.amazon.com/architecture
AWS Documentation (services)	https://docs.aws.amazon.com
AWS Frequently asked questions (FAQs)	https://aws.amazon.com/faqs
Getting Started Resource Center	https://aws.amazon.com/getting-started
AWS Builder Labs (Subscription-based hands-on labs)	https://aws.amazon.com/training/digital/aws-builder-labs
AWS Ramp-Up Guides	https://aws.amazon.com/training/ramp-up-guides

Architecture Center resource categories

Best practices

- Organized by technology category
- Presented in the context of a project's lifecycle steps

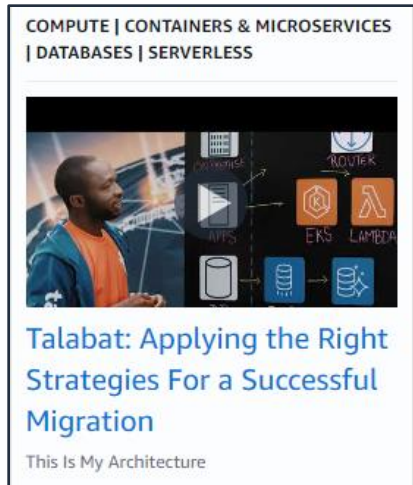
Video series

- Focused on practical use cases
- Presented by AWS Solutions Architects, AWS Partners, and customers

Libraries

- Organized into searchable and filterable collections
- Includes the following:
 - Reference architectures
 - Whitepapers
 - Quick Starts

Suggested AWS Video Series for architecting



This is My Architecture

AWS Cloud customers and partners explain elements of their specific architectural solutions.

<https://aws.amazon.com/architecture/this-is-my-architecture>



Back to Basics

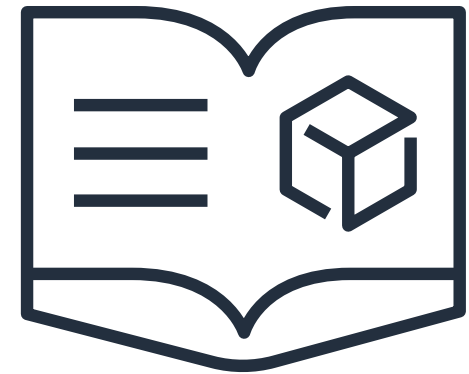
AWS SAs explain a specific architectural building block independent of a particular cloud solution.

<https://aws.amazon.com/architecture/back-to-basics>

AWS service documentation at docs.aws.amazon.com

Select a service from the Product guides and references section

- User guides, developer guides, and best practices are good sources for certification exam preparation.
- Helpful sections in these resources include the following:
 - What is
 - How it works
 - Getting started



AWS FAQ resources

Product-related

- Select a product to navigate to its product page FAQ.
- Examples include the following:
 - Amazon EC2 Auto Scaling FAQ
 - Amazon S3 FAQ

Cloud computing concepts

- Choose a question or follow the link to the Cloud Computing Concepts Hub to search for questions by topic.
- Examples include the following:
 - What is machine learning (ML)?
 - What is Data Mining?

Cloud comparison tool

- Choose a topic or follow the link to the Cloud Comparison tool to search for comparisons by topic.
- Examples include the following:
 - ETL vs. ELT
 - Artificial Intelligence vs Machine Learning

Getting Started Resource Center links

Hands-on Tutorials

- Filter by technology category and tutorial type (Getting Started guides, How-To guides, and tutorials).
- Available directly at <https://aws.amazon.com/getting-started/hands-on>

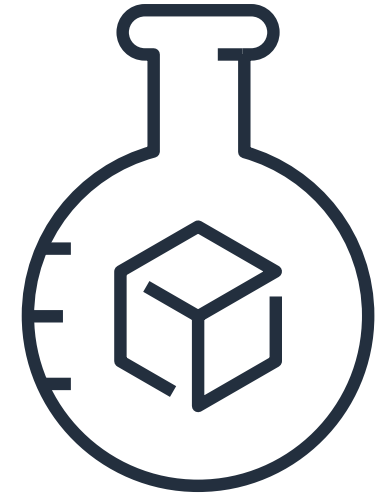
Decision guides

- Select a technology category to read the related guide.
- Available directly at <https://aws.amazon.com/getting-started/decision-guides>

AWS Builder Labs

Browse the catalog of self-paced labs available.

- Self-paced labs run in an AWS environment similar to the labs in the course.
- Labs require a Skill Builder subscription.



AWS Ramp-Up Guides

Explore the following guides by role, solution, or industry area.

- Downloadable guides with curated links from AWS classroom and digital curricula, video library, and AWS Builder Labs
- The Solutions Architect Ramp-Up Guide which includes specific resources from many of the resource types highlighted in this module.
- To access the Solutions Architect Ramp-Up Guide see https://d1.awsstatic.com/training-and-certification/ramp-up_guides/Ramp-Up_Guide_Architect.pdf





Module wrap-up

Bridging to Certification

Module summary

This module prepared you to do the following:

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Thank you

Corrections, feedback, or other questions?

Contact us at <https://support.aws.amazon.com/#/contacts/aws-academy>.